

Ross Strachan

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PERSONAL SUMMARY

Enthusiastic and detail-oriented administrator with experience in customer-facing roles, academic support, data handling and multilingual proofreading. Strong communication and organisation skills, with a proven ability to manage competing priorities, maintain accuracy and deliver a high standard of service in busy environments. Comfortable working independently or as part of a team, and experienced with Microsoft Office, document control and supporting users with clear, professional communication.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

December 2022 — September 2024

Private contract

Québec, Canada

- Conducted academic source verification and data-gathering to support a doctoral thesis in social communication.
- Processed, analysed and transformed raw datasets into professional, publication-ready graphs and data visualisations in Python.
- Provided multilingual proofreading and editorial layout support across chapters containing English, French and Japanese text.
- Established and manually implemented a framework of hundreds of typographical and formatting rules to ensure absolute consistency across the entire manuscript.
- Identified and corrected more than 2,500 grammatical, punctuation and typographical errors prior to official submission.

College Exam Marker

October — December 2023

Private contract

Québec, Canada

- Evaluated and marked hundreds of student submissions, applying complex grading rubrics to maintain institutional academic standards.
- Provided constructive, detailed written feedback to students to support their academic development.
- Managed sensitive student data and final grades confidentially, ensuring accurate data entry for final tracking.
- Prioritised a heavy workload independently to ensure all marking turnarounds met strict deadlines.

Café Assistant

July 2020 — September 2021

HMP Peterhead Prison Museum (Admiralty Gateway Charitable Trust)

Peterhead, Scotland

- Entrusted with full financial responsibility, including processing transactions efficiently using the POS system, cashing up the till, and securely handling cash volume using the on-site safes.
- Conducted daily inventory checks to ensure optimal stock levels and independently managed procurement, coordinating with suppliers to order over 100 different food, drink, and kitchen components.
- Resolved customer complaints and enquiries with diplomacy to ensure a positive visitor experience, resulting in regular mention in positive venue reviews.
- Learned basic British Sign Language to ensure d/Deaf and hard-of-hearing visitors felt comfortable and included.

EDUCATION

University of Aberdeen & The Open University

2017 — 2022

Completed coursework in Mathematics & Computer Science

- Completed two years of undergraduate-level study (DipHE equivalent) in calculus, linear algebra and software principles.
- Developed skills in analytical problem solving, academic writing and independent research.

North East Scotland College

2016 — 2017

HNC Applied Sciences

PROJECTS

Developer & Maintainer, QADDOE (reiwa.ca/qaddoe)

April 2023 — Present

- Engineered a cross-platform desktop application using Electron and TypeScript, authoring over 24,000 lines of code.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Teaching English as a Foreign Language (TEFL) Qualifi Level 5, The TEFL Academy

Expected July 2026

SKILLS

Personal — client collaboration, teamwork, data entry, document formatting, email communication, record keeping

Technical — Microsoft Office, software development, technical problem solving, data management, analytical skills

LANGUAGES

French — Advanced (Professional) Proficiency

CEFR C1–C2